[NEXT GEN SUMMIT · UYO]

Build. Ship. Get picked.



GORDIAN ETIM · DX & PRODUCT, AOMI LABS · @0XGORDIAN

PRESS SPACE TO START

The market is hard. What can you control?

[NOT UP TO YOU]

~~Who hires you.~~

~~Who accepts your work.~~

~~Who funds your idea.~~

[UP TO YOU]

- [ ] What you can do.
- [ ] Which problems you work on.
- [ ] What people can see of your work.
- [ ] What you learn each time.

This talk is about the second list.

Three words, three jobs.

01

Build

Make one small thing that fixes one real problem.

02

Ship

Put it where someone else can open it, use it and check it.

03

Get picked

Make what you can do easy for people to see.

If it only runs on your laptop, it isn't shipped.

I did the work before anyone paid me to.



CLEARED

LEVEL 1

On my own

Built small apps and demos. Tried other people's products and wrote down where I got stuck.

CLEARED

LEVEL 2

SaladCloud

Wrote docs and guides that helped developers run their apps on SaladCloud.

CLEARED

LEVEL 3

Mode Network

Built dev tools and AI agent integrations, and helped new builders get started on Mode.

NOW

LEVEL 4

Aomi Labs

Product engineering, DX, SDKs and apps for AI agents that handle crypto money safely.

LEVEL 5

???_

NEXT

~100 REJECTIONS

33 INTERVIEWS

6 FINAL ROUNDS

1 YES

INTERVIEWED WITH

Canva · Consensys · Arbitrum · Monad

Blockstream · Nethermind · Moniepoint · and more

Not every attempt got me the role I wanted. Every attempt left me with something I could show.

Start with a real problem.

A real problem is one someone has today, and you can tell when it's fixed.

01	**Apps you use daily**	Where did you get stuck?
02	**Open source**	The issues list is where people write down what's broken.
03	**Tutorials**	Follow the steps. Where they break is a problem.
04	**Hackathons**	Read how you'll be judged before you build.
05	**Bounties**	Paid tasks with a clear finish line.

Write your problem in one sentence. If nobody can check it, make it smaller.



TOO BIG

~~"Fix sign-up for every app in Nigeria."~~

Nobody can check it.

SMALL ENOUGH TO FINISH

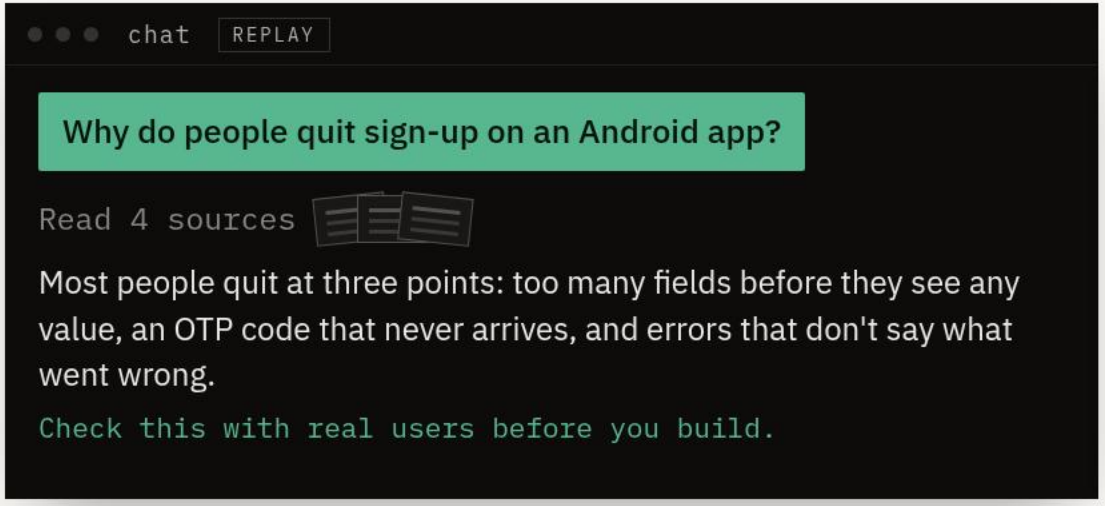
"New users can't finish this app's sign-up on Android."

You can test it today.

Pick AI tools by the job, not by the hype.

[01 · THINK AND RESEARCH]

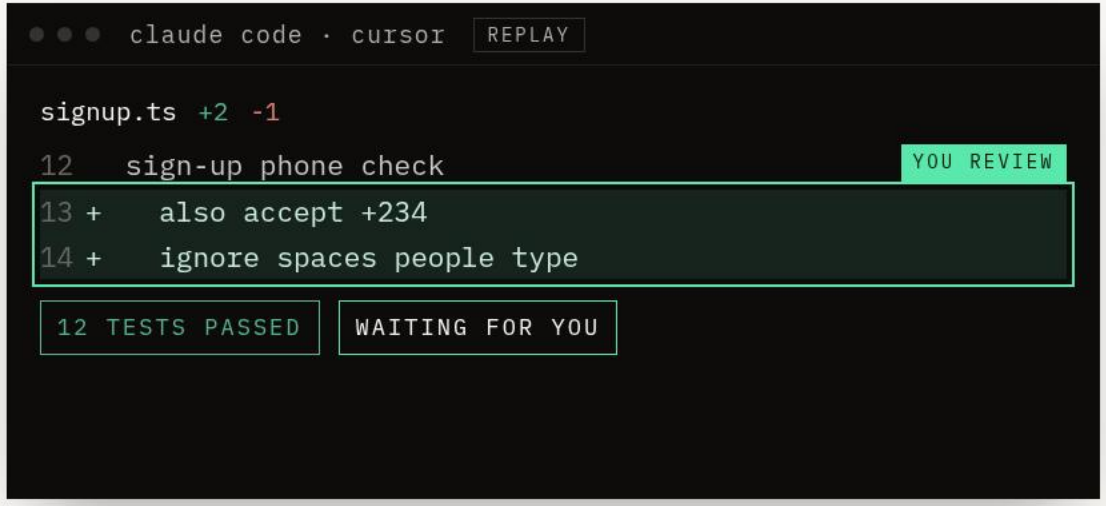
Chat assistants answer questions and help you plan. They can be wrong, so check what they say.



ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Grok · Perplexity

[02 · WRITE CODE]

A coding agent is AI that works inside your project. It opens files, changes them, runs the tests, then waits for you.

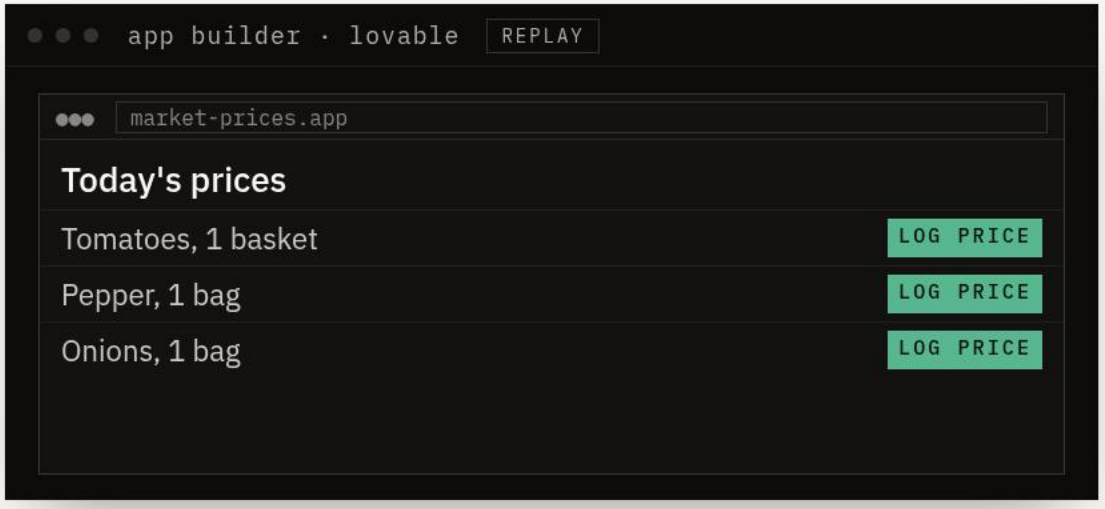


Claude Code · OpenAI Codex · Cursor · GitHub Copilot · Gemini CLI · Windsurf

Get it in front of people fast.

[03 · BUILD A FIRST VERSION]

App builders turn a plain description into an app you can click.

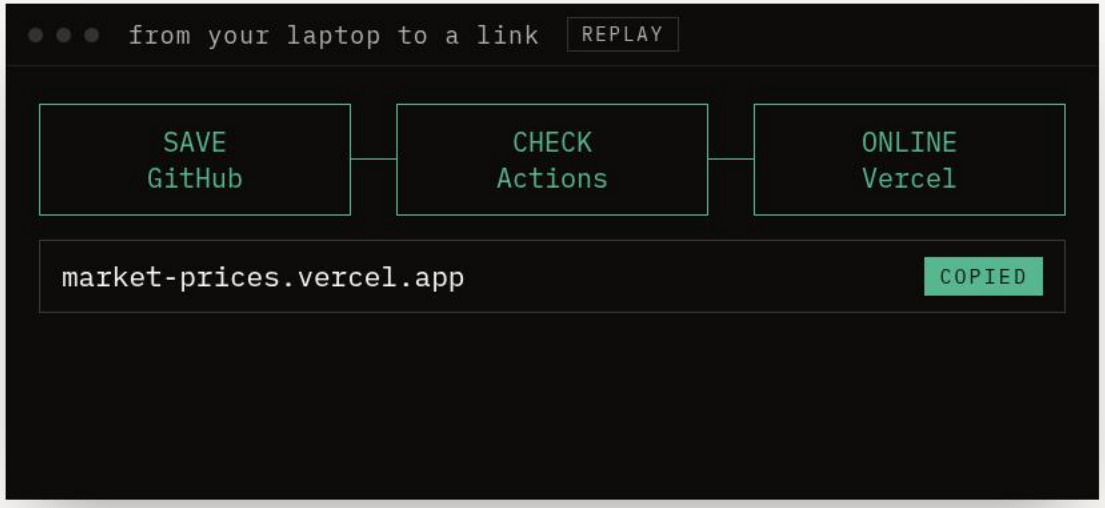


Replit · Lovable · Bolt.new · v0

Examples, not endorsements. Most have free plans.

[04 · PUT IT ONLINE]

GitHub keeps every version of your work. GitHub Actions tests it every time you save. Vercel turns it into a link anyone can open.



GitHub · GitHub Actions · Vercel

AI drafts it. You check it.

01	02	03	04	05	06
Understand	Explore	Plan	One small change	Test	Your review

AI writes the first draft.
Your name goes on the result.

- Is it correct?
- Is it safe?
- Does it do what was asked?

● AI · WAITING FOR YOU

If you can't explain a line, don't ship it.



Demo: one small fix, four steps.

1 · The prompt
0 files changed

Read first, ask me questions, don't touch files yet.

2 · The plan
2 questions

It asks two questions, then plans three steps.

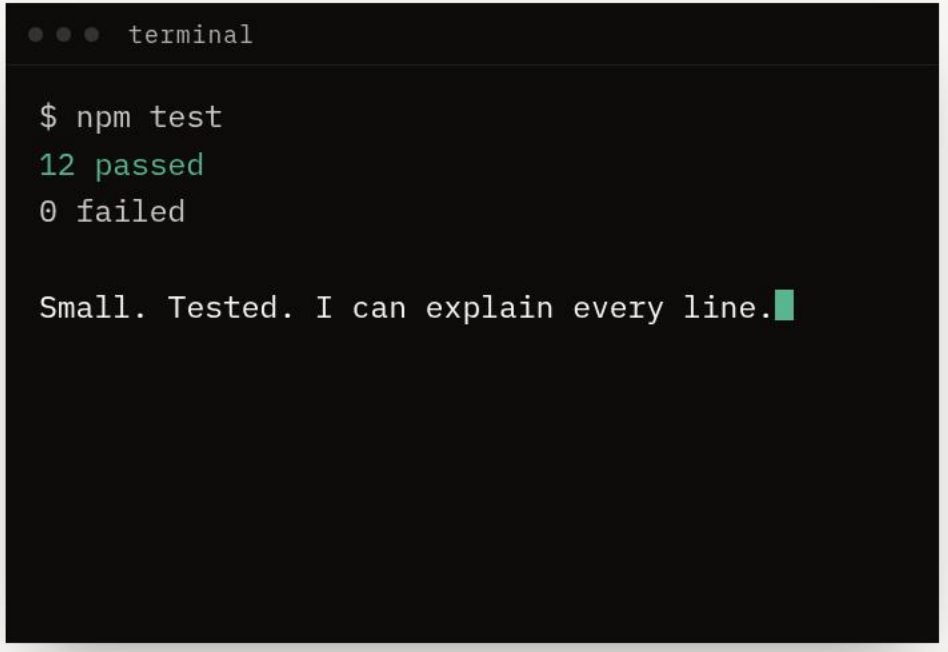
3 · The change
+2 -1

I ask "why?" about one line.

4 · The tests
12 passed

12 passed, 0 failed.

Small. Tested. I can explain every line.



Shipped means someone else can check it.

README.md · market-prices EXAMPLE

PROBLEM	Traders lose prices written on paper.
DEMO	60-second video, live link, code.
CHOICE	Used a spreadsheet so I could test it in a day.
NOT YET	English only. No login. 3 testers.
RESULT	**Didn't win. Shared it anyway.**

[BEFORE YOU SUBMIT]

- ☑ Someone else has tried it.
- ☑ A short demo video.
- ☑ Public code with a clear README.
- ☑ Your choices, explained.
- ☑ What's missing, said plainly.

Now anyone can judge it, even if it doesn't win.

Tell people what you built.

01 The problem, in one line.

02 A 30 to 60 second video.

03 The link and the code.

04 What doesn't work yet.

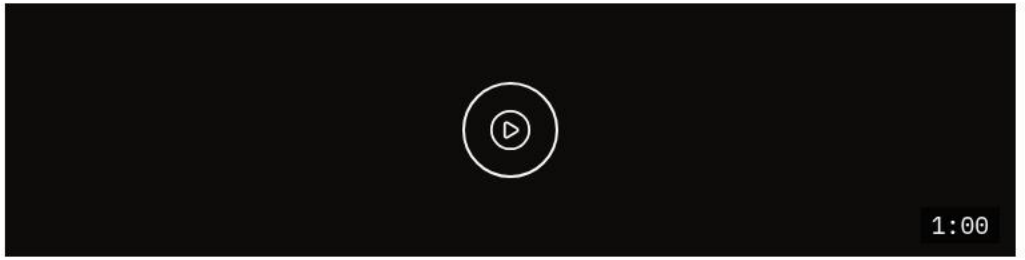
05 One clear ask.

Post it once. Then post what you changed.

You
@you

EXAMPLE

Traders near me write prices on paper and lose them. I built a small tool to log them. 60-second demo below. Live link and code in the replies. English only for now. If you sell in a market, try it and tell me what's missing.



market-prices.vercel.app · github.com/you/market-prices

SKIP S

Five ways this goes wrong.

01 The problem is too big to finish.

02 You wait until it's perfect.

03 You ship code you can't explain.

04 No README, no demo, so nobody can judge it.

05 You post once and go quiet.

Pick the one you've done. Fix that one first.

You built all weekend for a hackathon.
You didn't win.

What do you have on Monday?

No prize. You still left with six things.

They only count if people can see them. That's why you ship.



UNLOCKED 0 / 6 0000 XP

Build up proof people can see.

Proof is work someone else can open and check.

STEP 7 OF 7

Improve it, start the next one

A LOOP, NOT A LADDER

FINAL QUEST 48:00:00

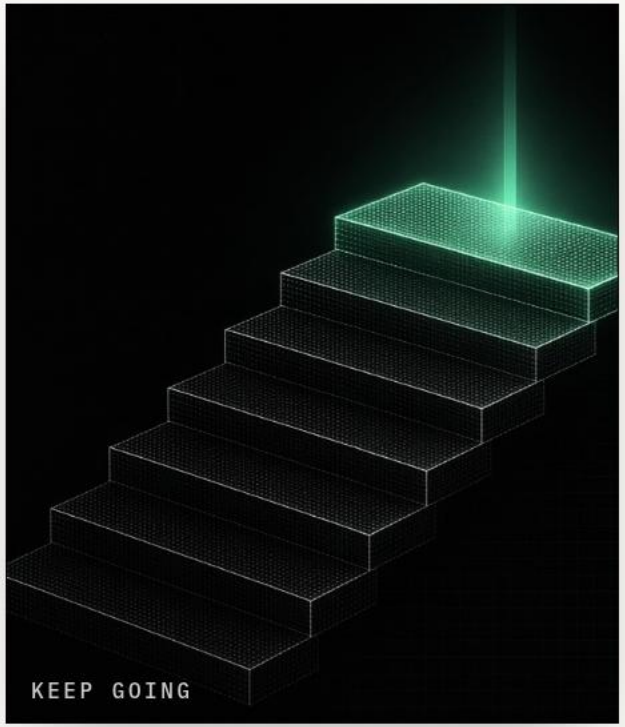
01 Pick one problem.

02 Build the smallest version that helps.

03 Publish it. Say what works and what doesn't yet.

04 Post it. Tag @0xgordian.

Getting picked means people can see what you can do. It's not a promise of a job.



Stop waiting.
Start building.

48 HOURS STARTS NOW

Tag @0xgordian with what you build.



Questions?

X	@0xgordian
GITHUB	github.com/0xgordian
SLIDES	summit-gordian.vercel.app

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SCAN · X.COM/0XGORDIAN